



General Assembly

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Agenda item 20 (b)

Globalization and interdependence: culture and sustainable development

Resolution adopted by the General Assembly on 4 September 2026

[without reference to a Main Committee ([A/80/L.102](#))]

80/308. International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development (2027–2036)

The General Assembly,

Reaffirming its resolution [70/1](#) of 25 September 2015, entitled “Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development”, in which it adopted a comprehensive, far-reaching and people-centred set of universal and transformative Sustainable Development Goals and targets, its commitment to working tirelessly for the full implementation of the Agenda by 2030, its recognition that eradicating poverty in all its forms and dimensions, including extreme poverty, is the greatest global challenge and an indispensable requirement for sustainable development, its commitment to achieving sustainable development in its three dimensions – economic, social and environmental – in a balanced and integrated manner, and to building upon the achievements of the Millennium Development Goals and seeking to address their unfinished business,

Recalling its resolutions [80/148](#) of 15 December 2025 on culture and sustainable development and [78/133](#) of 19 December 2023 on promoting creative economy for sustainable development,

Recalling also that, in the 2030 Agenda, inter alia, the natural and cultural diversity of the world is acknowledged, and it is recognized that all cultures and civilizations can contribute to, and are crucial enablers of, sustainable development,

Recognizing that culture is an essential component of human development, that it represents a source of identity, innovation and creativity for the individual and the community and that it is an important factor in social cohesion and inclusion and poverty eradication, providing for sustainable economic growth and ownership of development processes,



Recognizing also the power of culture as a driver of sustainable development, which contributes to fostering social inclusion and developing a strong and viable economic sector by generating income, creating decent jobs for all, and addressing both the economic and social dimensions of poverty through cultural heritage, including its protection and preservation, and cultural and creative sectors, while providing innovative and effective solutions to cross-cutting issues, such as education, health, gender equality and women's empowerment, technology and the environment,

Reaffirming the importance of the effective integration and mainstreaming of culture into economic, social and environmental development policies and strategies, and of ensuring adequate public investment in the protection and promotion of culture,

Welcoming the final declaration of the 2022 United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization World Conference on Cultural Policies and Sustainable Development, also known as "Mondiacult 2022", as well as the outcome document of Mondiacult 2025,

Emphasizing the unique mandate of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization in the field of culture, and its responsibility for the promotion, protection and safeguarding of cultural heritage, cultural rights, cultural diversity and the creative economy, in close synergy with education, science, communication and information,

Welcoming United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization resolution 43 C/41, adopted by consensus on 12 November 2025 at the forty-third session of the General Conference, in which the Conference proposed that the General Assembly consider the proclamation of an international decade of culture for sustainable development as soon as possible, preferably for the period 2027–2036, and invited the Assembly to consider the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization to serve as the lead United Nations agency for an international decade of culture for sustainable development,

Recalling Economic and Social Council resolutions [1980/67](#) of 25 July 1980 on international years and anniversaries and [1989/84](#) of 24 May 1989 on guidelines for international decades in economic and social fields and General Assembly resolutions [53/199](#) of 15 December 1998 and [61/185](#) of 20 December 2006 on the proclamation of international years,

1. *Decides* to proclaim 2027–2036 as the International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development, as proposed by the General Conference of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization in its resolution 43 C/41, within existing structures, to represent a unique opportunity for humanity to use the critical role that culture plays in the pursuit of sustainable development, as well as in responding to the complex challenges of our time, to ensure a safe and prosperous future for all;

2. *Invites* the Governments of the States Members of the United Nations and other relevant stakeholders, including global, regional and subregional organizations, academia, civil society organizations, the private sector and the media, to actively support the implementation of the Decade, including through voluntary contributions, as appropriate;

3. *Invites* the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization to lead the implementation of the Decade, in consultation with Member States and in collaboration with other relevant organizations of the United Nations

system and other stakeholders, to identify and develop activities and programmes, including a plan of action, within their mandates;

4. *Encourages* international cooperation, including South-South and triangular cooperation, capacity-building, technical assistance, knowledge-sharing and partnerships, to support developing countries in enhancing the contribution of culture to sustainable development;

5. *Stresses* that the costs of all the activities that may arise from the implementation of the present resolution should be met through voluntary contributions, including from the private sector;

6. *Invites* the Secretary-General, bearing in mind upcoming negotiations on sustainable development, to inform the General Assembly about the implementation of the Decade on the basis of a midterm progress report to be prepared by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization in 2031, as well as the subsequent reactions of the States members of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization to the report.

*114th plenary meeting
4 September 2026*